

MUSIC FESTIVAL

Quintessential Melodies

The term Baajaa Gaajaa implies many musical instruments playing together in celebration. The festival Baajaa Gaajaa 2009 will showcase different facets of music. "It's not just music but the different trends that are shaping the industry. This will be discussed and debated during the three days," says Shubha Mudgal who along with husband Aneesh Pradhan has conceptualised and curated the festival. The inaugural function includes intense drumming and the melody of the shehnai. The drum ensemble will be led by well-known percussionist Pratap Rath and Pramod Gaekwad will head the shehnai group.

Classical musicians often die in penury without insurance. The seminar, Towards a Sound Future,

will discuss insurance and financial strategies for musicians, instrument-makers and other agencies involved in music. Other interesting seminars at the festival will talk about intellectual property rights with reference to music and experimentation in contemporary music. And for those who treasure memorabilia, there will be an archival photo exhibition. And if one is looking for rare music, a stall will be put up by Sangeet Kendra, Ahmedabad. Documentary films based on music like *Bishar Blues*, *Leaving Home* and *Laya* will be screened as well. The festival will conclude with a concert featuring Pandit Shiv Kumar Sharma (santoor) and Dr M. Balamuralikrishna (vocal). From February 6 to 8 at Ishanya, Pune.

by S. Sahaya Ranjit

PANDIT SHIV KUMAR SHARMA (LEFT) AND M. BALAMURALIKRISHNA



VIKRAM SHARMA

NARENDRA BISHT

ABHISHEK HAZRA



ART EXHIBITION

Shades of HISTORY

Abhishek Hazra's recent works, *Inheritance of Alpha-numerica Characters*, experiment an engagement with the social history of science and the way in which the practice of science is deeply contextualised within the larger discourse of the power and knowledge system. The works are also about negotiating with the inheritance of discourses like Orientalism or Stalinism and finding ways to critically engage with the legacy of the past. Hazra's pieces show his continuing interest in the way in which science journalism and information visualisation participate in the complex dynamics of knowledge dissemination. He finds multiple ways to create and show his works, some of which are performance-oriented. The multiple modalities include videos, the spoken word, digital prints and the artist's books. Till February 21, at Gallery SKE, Bangalore.

by Nirmala Ravindran